

Parent Guidance — Design Guidelines

Design system of the PG-Live prototype · Updated October 1, 2026

Guidelines for the **PG-Live** prototype (parentguidance.org), written from the **prototype's real code** (`src/app`) and organized with the method of Scalar's design system.

- **The visual identity** (colors, typography, radii, shadows, buttons and animation) comes from what the prototype already used: the most repeated values became tokens and the one-off values were consolidated.
- **The method** comes from Scalar: everything comes from tokens, closed scales, button hierarchy, accessibility and a reduced-motion contract.

Status: the prototype already follows these guidelines (final audit in [section 5.6](#)). Every new screen or component must follow them from the start.

Contents

#	Guide	Content
1	Foundations	Palette, contrast, Poppins typography, spacing, radii and shadows
2	Buttons	Styles, sizes, states, the <code><Button></code> component and accessibility
3	Layout	Containers, breakpoints, vertical rhythm, grids and patterns (cards, filter bar, banners, pop-ups, video)
4	Motion	Animation with <code>motion</code> , durations, easing and reduced-motion
5	Prototype audit	What was fixed, how it was verified and what is still pending

PDF version: `docs/guidelines/pdf/en/` has one PDF per guide plus one with all of them (`Parent-Guidance-Design-Guidelines-complete.pdf`). They are generated from these `.md` files; when a guide changes, they need to be generated again. The Spanish version lives in `docs/guidelines/`.

Where everything lives

File	What it is
<code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>	CSS variables (<code>--pg-*</code>) and their Tailwind v4 mapping (<code>bg-pg-navy</code> , <code>rounded-pg-md</code> , <code>shadow-pg-card</code> , <code>max-w-pg-page</code> ...)
<code>src/styles/accessibility.css</code>	Global visible focus and the reduced-motion rule
<code>src/app/components/Button.tsx</code>	<code><Button></code> , <code><ButtonLink></code> , <code><ButtonAnchor></code> and <code>buttonClass()</code>
<code>src/app/components/UnifiedCard.tsx</code>	Standard card (resources, courses, help lines)
<code>src/app/mhs/EventModal.tsx</code>	Event pop-up (accessible dialog pattern)
<code>guidelines/Guidelines.md</code>	Short summary for Figma Make (the file its AI reads when generating screens)

Visual personality

Parent Guidance supports families through sensitive topics (mental health, crisis, parenting). The interface must feel **warm, calm and trustworthy**:

- Warm cream background, deep navy text and teal/sage accents.
- Soft shapes: rounded corners, subtle navy-tinted shadows, never hard black ones.
- Calm motion: short, gentle entrances, nothing that bounces or blinks.
- Readability first: the audience is parents, often on their phones and under stress.

What we took from Scalar and what we didn't

Adopted (the method):

- Token rule: no hex, size or shadow written "by hand"; everything comes from `tokens.css` .
- Closed type and spacing scales; any new value is assigned the nearest step.
- Button hierarchy: one Primary per section, labels that start with a verb, complete states (Focus, Loading, Disabled), 44px minimum touch area.
- Grids that degrade in steps (3 → 2 → 1 columns).
- Safe, unhurried motion with duration bands and a mandatory reduced-motion contract.

Discarded:

- Scalar's blue palette ( `#037de8` ...) and the Inter typeface: Parent Guidance has its own brand.
- Scalar's 1160px container: the prototype uses 1280px.
- GSAP/ScrollTrigger, parallax, marquee, spotlight bento and the "Living Model" diagram: they don't fit a website that supports families, and the prototype already uses `motion` .

Rule #1

No color, font size, radius or shadow is written as a loose value (`text-[#1c3243]` , `text-[13px]` , `shadow-[...]` , `text-gray-700`). Use the tokens in `tokens.css` . If something is missing, first add it as a token here (and in Figma), then use it.

Accepted exceptions: colors inside SVG logos (brand art), course category palettes (data colors) and reading widths of hero text (`max-w-[480px]` ...).

How to check a screen

1. Review it at **390, 768, 1024 and 1280px**: no horizontal scroll and no squeezed text.
2. Go through it with the keyboard (Tab, Enter, Esc): everything clickable can be reached and shows focus.
3. AA contrast on all text (table in [section 1.1](#)).
4. Buttons use the component, headings follow the scale, no bouncing animations.